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LIMINAL PSYCHIATRY, LLC

PRIVACY, SECURITY, CONFIDENTIALITY, AND HIPAA COMPLIANCE POLICY AND WORKFORCE ACKNOWLEDGMENT

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Policy Owner: Privacy and Security Officer

Approved By: Founder/CEO

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PRIVACY AND SECURITY CONTACTS

Privacy and Security Officer: Gregory M. McNeff

Incident-Reporting Email: gmcneff@liminalpsychiatry.org

Incident-Reporting Telephone Number: 256-293-2515

1. PURPOSE

Liminal Psychiatry, LLC (“Liminal” or the “Practice”) is committed to protecting the privacy, security, confidentiality, integrity, and availability of patient information.

This Policy establishes the responsibilities of all individuals who create, access, receive, review, use, disclose, transmit, store, maintain, or dispose of Protected Health Information (“PHI”) or electronic Protected Health Information (“ePHI”) on behalf of Liminal.

This Policy is intended to:

- a. Protect patients from unauthorized access, use, or disclosure of their information;

- b. Establish clear rules for accessing and handling PHI;
- c. Ensure that PHI is used only for legitimate, authorized purposes;
- d. Establish security requirements for devices, systems, communication platforms, remote work, artificial intelligence tools, and third-party applications;
- e. Establish procedures for reporting suspected privacy or security incidents; and
- f. Document each workforce member's agreement to comply with Liminal's privacy and security requirements.

2. SCOPE

This Policy applies to every member of the Liminal workforce, including, as applicable:

- Employees;
- Independent contractors;
- Founders, officers, directors, and executives;
- Physicians, nurse practitioners, nurses, therapists, and other clinicians;
- Administrative, scheduling, billing, credentialing, and human-resources personnel;
- Students, interns, trainees, and volunteers;
- Consultants, advisors, developers, information-technology personnel, and vendors with authorized access;
- DBQ reviewers, collaborating professionals, and individuals providing clinical documentation support; and
- Any other individual working under Liminal's direction or receiving access to Liminal systems, facilities, accounts, records, or patient information.

Compliance with this Policy is a condition of continued access to Liminal systems and information.

This Policy does not replace any Business Associate Agreement, employment agreement, independent-contractor agreement, confidentiality agreement, clinical collaboration agreement, or other agreement that applies to an individual's relationship with Liminal.

3. APPLICABLE LAW

Workforce members shall comply with all applicable federal and state privacy, security, confidentiality, professional-licensure, and record-protection laws, including, as applicable:

- The Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (“HIPAA”);
- The Health Information Technology for Economic and Clinical Health Act (“HITECH”);
- The HIPAA Privacy, Security, Breach Notification, and Enforcement Rules;
- Federal confidentiality requirements applicable to substance-use-disorder patient records under 42 C.F.R. Part 2, when applicable;
- Applicable New York, Alabama, and other state privacy, mental-health, telehealth, cybersecurity, and health-record laws;
- Professional licensing-board requirements; and
- Liminal’s policies, procedures, patient authorizations, contractual obligations, and Notices of Privacy Practices.

When more than one law or policy applies, Liminal will follow the requirement providing the greater protection unless otherwise directed by legal counsel.

Questions concerning which law applies must be referred to the Privacy Officer. Workforce members shall not independently make legal determinations concerning the disclosure of PHI.

4. DEFINITIONS

For purposes of this Policy:

“Protected Health Information” or “PHI” means individually identifiable health information created, received, maintained, or transmitted by or on behalf of Liminal, whether oral, written, photographic, or electronic.

“Electronic Protected Health Information” or “ePHI” means PHI created, received, maintained, or transmitted electronically.

PHI may include, without limitation:

- A patient's name, initials, address, telephone number, email address, date of birth, or other identifying information;
- Appointment and scheduling information;
- Diagnoses, symptoms, medications, treatment plans, clinical notes, psychotherapy information, screening results, laboratory information, and billing information;
- Insurance information and identification numbers;
- Disability Benefits Questionnaires and related military or Department of Veterans Affairs documentation;
- Messages, voicemails, emails, photographs, recordings, screenshots, forms, and attachments containing patient information; and
- Information that does not contain a patient's name but could reasonably be used to identify the patient when combined with other information.

"Minimum Necessary" means limiting access, use, disclosure, and requests for PHI to the amount reasonably necessary to perform an authorized responsibility.

"Security Incident" includes any attempted or successful unauthorized access, use, disclosure, alteration, loss, destruction, or interference involving PHI, ePHI, Liminal systems, or system operations.

5. GENERAL CONFIDENTIALITY OBLIGATION

All patient information is confidential.

Workforce members may access, use, or disclose PHI only:

- a. To perform assigned and authorized responsibilities;
- b. Within the scope of their role;
- c. Through Practice-approved systems and workflows;
- d. In accordance with applicable law and Liminal policies; and
- e. To the minimum extent reasonably necessary for the authorized purpose.

The obligation to protect patient confidentiality continues after the workforce member's employment, contract, assignment, or other relationship with Liminal ends.

6. ROLE-BASED AND MINIMUM-NECESSARY ACCESS

Access to PHI will be based on job responsibilities and legitimate business or clinical need.

Workforce members shall not:

- Access the record of a patient who is not assigned to them or whose information is not required for their work;
- Access the records of friends, family members, coworkers, public figures, former patients, or other individuals out of curiosity or personal interest;
- Search for information unrelated to an assigned task;
- Access more information than is reasonably necessary;
- Continue accessing a record after the assigned responsibility has ended;
- Use PHI for personal purposes, private disputes, employment decisions unrelated to authorized duties, or personal financial benefit; or
- Ask another person to access information on their behalf when they are not authorized to access it themselves.

Access may be monitored and audited. The fact that a workforce member can technically open a record does not mean that the workforce member is authorized to do so.

7. APPROVED SYSTEMS AND PLATFORMS

PHI may be created, accessed, transmitted, or stored only through systems approved by Liminal's Privacy Officer, Security Officer, and authorized technology administrator.

Approved systems may include, when formally authorized and appropriately configured:

- Liminal-managed Google Workspace accounts;
- Liminal-approved electronic health record and practice-management systems;
- Liminal's Spruce account and approved patient-communication workflows;
- Liminal-approved electronic-signature systems;

- Liminal-approved billing, credentialing, scheduling, and document-management systems;
- Liminal-managed cloud-storage locations;
- Liminal-approved telehealth platforms; and
- Other systems specifically approved in writing.

The current list of approved systems shall be maintained in Appendix A or a separate Approved Systems Register.

A vendor's marketing claim that its service is "HIPAA compliant" does not constitute Liminal approval.

No workforce member may independently purchase, activate, install, test, connect, or authorize a third-party service that will create, receive, maintain, transmit, or gain access to PHI.

Liminal will determine whether a Business Associate Agreement or other contractual safeguard is required before a system or vendor is approved.

8. UNIQUE USER ACCOUNTS AND PASSWORD SECURITY

Each workforce member must use their own individually assigned account and credentials.

The following are prohibited:

- Shared usernames or shared login credentials;
- Logging in under another workforce member's account;
- Allowing another person to use one's account;
- Sharing passwords through email, text message, Slack, Telegram, or another messaging platform;
- Saving passwords in an unsecured document, notebook, spreadsheet, browser profile, or message;
- Reusing a Liminal password for a personal account; and
- Circumventing multi-factor authentication or another access-control measure.

Workforce members must:

- Use strong, unique passwords or passphrases;
- Use a Liminal-approved password manager when provided or authorized;
- Enable multi-factor authentication whenever required or available;
- Protect authentication codes and recovery information;
- Lock devices when stepping away; and
- immediately report suspected credential theft or unauthorized account access.

9. DEVICES AND REMOTE WORK

PHI may be accessed from a personal device only when the device and access method have been approved by Liminal.

Any device used to access PHI must have, as applicable:

- A password, passcode, biometric control, or equivalent access protection;
- Full-device encryption where supported;
- Automatic screen locking;
- Current operating-system and security updates;
- Active antivirus, anti-malware, endpoint-protection, or other required security software;
- Secure network settings;
- Multi-factor authentication;
- Remote-location or remote-wipe capability where required; and
- Lock-screen notifications configured so that PHI is not visible to unauthorized persons.

Workforce members shall not:

- Access PHI from a shared or public computer;

- Allow household members, friends, or other unauthorized persons to use a device while a Liminal account or patient record is accessible;
- Leave PHI visible on an unattended screen;
- Conduct patient-related work where conversations or screens can be observed or overheard;
- Access PHI over unsecured public Wi-Fi unless using a Liminal-approved secure connection or virtual private network;
- Save PHI to an unapproved personal device, USB drive, external hard drive, photo library, downloads folder, notes application, or personal cloud backup; or
- Permit automatic syncing of PHI to personal accounts or services.

Remote work involving PHI must be performed in a private environment. Headphones, privacy screens, closed doors, and other safeguards shall be used when appropriate.

10. EMAIL, TEXTING, MESSAGING, AND TELEPHONE COMMUNICATION

A. Practice Email

Patient information may be sent only through a Liminal-managed email account and only when permitted by Liminal policy.

Before sending PHI, the workforce member must:

- Confirm the recipient's identity and email address;
- Confirm that all attachments belong to the intended patient;
- Review autofill and autocomplete recipients;
- Use secure or encrypted transmission features when required; and
- Limit the content to the minimum information necessary.

PHI shall never be forwarded to or stored in a personal email account.

B. Spruce and Patient Messaging

The Liminal Spruce account is the preferred platform for patient messaging when authorized by the Practice.

The encrypted Spruce application should be used when available and appropriate.

Standard SMS messaging through a Liminal-approved workflow may be used only in accordance with Practice policy, the patient's communication preferences, and minimum-necessary principles.

Highly sensitive clinical details should not be placed in ordinary SMS messages when a more secure method is reasonably available.

C. Personal Messaging Applications

Workforce members shall not communicate patient-specific information through personal:

- Text messages or iMessage accounts;
- WhatsApp;
- Telegram;
- Facebook Messenger;
- Instagram or other social-media messaging;
- Signal, unless specifically approved for a defined Practice use;
- Personal email; or
- Any other unapproved communication platform.

Liminal organizational or founders' group chats shall not be used to discuss identifiable patient information unless the platform and specific workflow have been formally approved for that purpose.

D. Slack and Internal Collaboration Platforms

PHI may be placed in Slack or another internal collaboration platform only when:

- The workspace has been approved for the use of PHI;
- Required contractual and security safeguards are in place;
- The channel or workflow is authorized for patient information;
- Access is limited to individuals who require the information; and

- Only the minimum necessary information is included.

The default rule is that patient-specific information should not be placed in general channels, social channels, executive channels, founders' channels, or other broadly accessible discussions.

E. Voicemail

Voicemails should contain the minimum information necessary. Workforce members must follow any patient request concerning confidential communications and avoid including diagnoses, medication names, test results, or other sensitive information unless specifically authorized and necessary.

11. ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, AUTOMATION, TRANSCRIPTION, AND THIRD-PARTY TOOLS

PHI shall not be entered, pasted, uploaded, transmitted, recorded, or otherwise disclosed to an artificial-intelligence, automation, transcription, documentation, analytics, or productivity tool unless the specific tool and workflow have been approved in writing by Liminal.

This prohibition includes, without limitation, unapproved use of:

- Generative artificial-intelligence systems;
- Chatbots and large-language-model tools;
- Automated note-writing or transcription applications;
- Meeting-recording and meeting-summary tools;
- Browser extensions;
- Grammar, editing, or writing-assistance applications;
- Personal virtual assistants;
- Data-analytics platforms;
- Workflow-automation services;
- Customer-relationship-management systems; and
- Software-development, debugging, or technical-support tools.

No workforce member may connect an application, bot, integration, application programming interface, or automation to Liminal's:

- Email;
- Google Drive;
- Slack;
- Spruce;
- Calendar;
- Electronic health record;
- Billing system;
- Credentialing system; or
- Other Practice account

without prior written authorization from both the designated Privacy or Security Officer and the authorized technology administrator.

Patient information shall not be used to train, fine-tune, test, evaluate, demonstrate, or develop an artificial-intelligence system or software product unless Liminal has completed the necessary legal, privacy, security, ethical, and contractual review.

Removing a patient's name does not automatically make information de-identified. Workforce members shall not independently determine that information is de-identified unless they have been trained and authorized to do so.

12. SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT, TESTING, AND TECHNICAL SUPPORT

Production PHI shall not be copied into development, demonstration, testing, staging, sandbox, or training environments unless the use has been specifically approved and appropriate safeguards are in place.

Developers and technology personnel shall not:

- Use real patient records as sample data without written authorization;
- Place PHI in source-code repositories, bug-tracking systems, screenshots, screen recordings, technical tickets, or vendor-support chats unless specifically authorized;

- Download production databases or records to personal devices;
- Provide system access to another developer, subcontractor, or vendor without authorization;
- Create undisclosed administrator accounts, integrations, bots, or access tokens; or
- Retain access after the assigned work has ended.

Test data should be synthetic or properly de-identified whenever reasonably possible.

All administrative credentials, encryption keys, recovery codes, domain credentials, application tokens, source-code repositories, and vendor accounts created for Liminal must remain under Liminal's ownership and control.

13. PATIENT IDENTITY AND RECIPIENT VERIFICATION

Before discussing or disclosing PHI, workforce members must reasonably verify the identity and authority of the person receiving the information.

When appropriate, at least two patient identifiers should be used, such as:

- Full name;
- Date of birth;
- Address;
- Telephone number;
- Email address; or
- Another identifier approved by Liminal.

Before sending records, prescriptions, forms, DBQs, letters, or other documents, the workforce member must confirm:

- The correct patient;
- The correct recipient;
- The correct email address, fax number, portal destination, or mailing address;
- The correct attachments; and

- The recipient's authority to receive the information.

Information shall not be disclosed to family members, partners, employers, attorneys, schools, government agencies, or other third parties unless the disclosure is authorized or otherwise permitted by law and Practice policy.

14. CLINICAL DISCUSSIONS AND PHYSICAL PRIVACY

Patient information shall be discussed only with individuals who are authorized and need the information.

Workforce members must avoid discussing patients:

- In elevators, hallways, restaurants, airports, rideshares, or public locations;
- In common areas where unauthorized individuals may overhear;
- On speakerphone when unauthorized individuals are present;
- In personal conversations with friends or family;
- In social-media posts or private social-media groups;
- In educational discussions that have not been approved; or
- In a manner that could allow the patient to be identified.

When consultation is necessary, workforce members must use approved communication methods and share only the information reasonably needed for the consultation.

15. PHOTOGRAPHS, SCREENSHOTS, RECORDINGS, AND COPIES

Workforce members shall not photograph, screenshot, screen-record, audio-record, or video-record PHI unless:

- The activity is required for an authorized purpose;
- The activity is permitted by law;
- Required patient consent or authorization has been obtained;
- The device and storage location are approved; and
- The recording or image is handled according to Liminal policy.

PHI shall not be stored in a personal camera roll, photo backup, voicemail archive, audio-recording application, notes application, or personal cloud account.

Screenshots containing PHI shall not be included in group chats, technical-support communications, presentations, teaching materials, or demonstrations without authorization and appropriate safeguards.

16. PRINTING, DOWNLOADING, AND LOCAL STORAGE

Workforce members should avoid printing, downloading, or locally storing PHI unless reasonably necessary for an authorized responsibility.

When PHI must be printed or temporarily stored:

- Access must be restricted to authorized individuals;
- Paper records must be stored in a locked or otherwise secure location;
- Documents must not be left in vehicles, public locations, shared workspaces, or unattended areas;
- Electronic files must be stored only in an approved location;
- PHI must not be stored indefinitely in downloads folders or on desktops;
- Copies must be securely deleted when no longer needed; and
- Paper must be destroyed by cross-cut shredding or an approved secure-destruction service.

PHI shall not be placed in ordinary trash, recycling bins, or unsecured disposal containers.

17. SOCIAL MEDIA, MARKETING, EDUCATION, AND PUBLIC COMMUNICATION

Workforce members shall not disclose patient information through social media, websites, podcasts, presentations, publications, advertising, media interviews, online reviews, or public conversations.

This restriction applies even when:

- The patient has publicly identified themselves as a patient;
- The patient has posted about Liminal;

- A workforce member believes the information is complimentary;
- A name has been omitted but the circumstances could identify the patient;
- The disclosure is made in a private group; or
- The workforce member is responding to criticism or a negative review.

Patient testimonials, case examples, educational materials, photographs, recordings, or stories may be used only after appropriate review and authorization.

Workforce members shall not confirm or deny that an individual is or was a Liminal patient when responding publicly.

18. RESEARCH, QUALITY IMPROVEMENT, AND DATA ANALYSIS

PHI may not be used for research, publication, external analysis, product development, or academic collaboration without prior approval from Liminal and completion of all required legal, privacy, ethical, and institutional-review procedures.

Internal quality-improvement activities must also be authorized and limited to the information reasonably necessary.

Workforce members shall not independently create patient datasets, export patient lists, or provide information to researchers, consultants, investors, technology companies, or academic partners.

19. LEGAL REQUESTS, SUBPOENAS, LAW ENFORCEMENT, AND GOVERNMENT INQUIRIES

All subpoenas, court orders, attorney requests, law-enforcement requests, licensing-board inquiries, government requests, audits, and record demands must be immediately sent to the Privacy Officer or legal counsel.

Workforce members shall not:

- Release records independently;
- Confirm that an individual is a patient;
- Answer substantive questions about patient care;
- Sign an affidavit or certification concerning records;
- Delete, alter, conceal, or destroy requested information; or

- Promise that information will or will not be released.

Emergency, mandatory-reporting, and imminent-safety situations must be handled according to applicable law, clinical judgment, and Liminal's emergency and mandatory-reporting procedures.

20. PATIENT PRIVACY RIGHTS AND REQUESTS

Requests involving a patient's privacy rights must be promptly referred to the Privacy Officer or designated records personnel.

These may include requests for:

- Access to or copies of records;
- Amendment of records;
- Restrictions on use or disclosure;
- Confidential communications;
- An accounting of certain disclosures;
- Revocation of an authorization;
- Information about a privacy incident; or
- Filing a privacy complaint.

Workforce members shall not deny, approve, delay, or make promises about a request unless authorized to manage that request.

21. PRIVACY AND SECURITY INCIDENT REPORTING

Every actual or suspected privacy or security incident must be reported immediately after discovery and no later than twenty-four hours after discovery.

A workforce member should report an incident even when:

- The workforce member is unsure whether PHI was accessed;
- The information was sent to another Liminal workforce member;
- The recipient says they deleted the information;

- The workforce member believes the risk is small;
- The incident was accidental;
- No patient has complained; or
- The workforce member caused the incident.

Reportable events include, without limitation:

- An email, text, fax, document, prescription, or message sent to the wrong person;
- Accessing or opening the wrong patient record;
- Unauthorized access to a patient record;
- Lost or stolen devices;
- Lost paper records;
- Compromised passwords or accounts;
- Suspicious login activity;
- Phishing emails, malicious links, malware, or ransomware;
- PHI entered into an unapproved artificial-intelligence or transcription tool;
- PHI shared in an unauthorized Slack channel, Telegram group, text thread, or email account;
- Improper screenshots, photographs, recordings, or downloads;
- Conversations overheard by an unauthorized individual;
- A patient receiving another patient's information;
- Improper disposal of PHI;
- Unapproved vendor, developer, or contractor access;
- Unauthorized software integrations or access tokens;
- System outages, data corruption, or interference affecting patient information; and
- Any suspected violation of this Policy.

Reports shall be made to the designated Privacy Officer, Security Officer, or incident-reporting contact.

Workforce members shall provide all available information and cooperate fully with the investigation.

22. IMMEDIATE RESPONSE TO A SUSPECTED INCIDENT

When a suspected incident occurs, the workforce member should, when safe and reasonably possible:

- a. Stop the unauthorized disclosure or activity;
- b. Notify the designated incident-reporting contact immediately;
- c. Preserve relevant emails, messages, logs, screenshots, devices, and other evidence;
- d. Disconnect a potentially compromised device from the network when instructed or when necessary to prevent ongoing harm;
- e. Follow instructions from the Privacy Officer, Security Officer, technology administrator, or legal counsel;
- f. Avoid independently contacting patients, regulators, the media, law enforcement, vendors, or other affected persons unless directed; and
- g. Avoid deleting, altering, wiping, or destroying potentially relevant information.

Liminal will determine whether an event constitutes a reportable breach and what notification, mitigation, documentation, or corrective action is required.

23. NO RETALIATION FOR GOOD-FAITH REPORTING

Liminal prohibits intimidation, retaliation, threats, discrimination, or adverse treatment against an individual who, in good faith:

- Reports a suspected privacy or security concern;
- Participates in an investigation;
- Files a complaint;
- Opposes conduct reasonably believed to violate applicable privacy law; or
- Cooperates with an authorized government investigation.

Knowingly false reports or deliberate misuse of the reporting process may be addressed under applicable personnel or contractual procedures.

24. TRAINING REQUIREMENTS

All workforce members with access to PHI or Liminal systems must complete:

- Initial HIPAA privacy and security training before or promptly after receiving access;
- Liminal-specific privacy and security training;
- Training concerning approved systems and communication platforms;
- Cybersecurity and phishing-awareness training when assigned;
- Additional role-specific training; and
- Refresher training at least annually and whenever material policy, system, legal, or workflow changes occur.

Training may also be required following a privacy incident, security incident, audit finding, or identified compliance concern.

A general HIPAA course certificate does not replace required training on Liminal's policies, systems, and workflows.

Training completion shall be documented and retained by Liminal.

25. BUSINESS ASSOCIATES, CONTRACTORS, AND SUBCONTRACTORS

Contractors and vendors may be required to execute a Business Associate Agreement or other privacy and security agreement before receiving access to PHI.

No workforce member may authorize a contractor, consultant, developer, vendor, subcontractor, or other third party to access PHI without prior approval.

Contractors shall not provide PHI or system access to their employees, agents, assistants, or subcontractors unless:

- Liminal has approved the arrangement;
- Required agreements are in place;
- Access is limited to the assigned purpose; and

- The individual is subject to appropriate confidentiality and security obligations.

26. ACCESS CHANGES, SEPARATION, AND TERMINATION

Access to PHI and Liminal systems may be modified, suspended, or revoked whenever:

- A workforce member changes roles;
- Access is no longer required;
- An assignment ends;
- A contract expires or is terminated;
- A security concern exists;
- A policy violation is suspected; or
- Liminal otherwise determines that access should be restricted.

Upon separation or termination, the workforce member must:

- Stop accessing all Liminal accounts and records;
- Return Practice-owned equipment, documents, credentials, keys, and property;
- Provide Liminal with control of Practice-owned accounts, domains, data, source code, integrations, and administrative credentials;
- Remove PHI from approved personal devices as directed;
- Return or securely destroy all copies of PHI;
- Confirm completion of required return or destruction procedures; and
- Continue protecting the confidentiality of all information learned during the relationship.

Workforce members shall not retain PHI as a personal work sample, reference, portfolio item, contact list, template, training example, or evidence of prior work unless specifically authorized by law and Liminal.

27. SANCTIONS AND CORRECTIVE ACTION

Violations of this Policy may result in corrective or disciplinary action based on the nature, severity, intent, frequency, and consequences of the conduct.

Actions may include:

- Additional education or retraining;
- Increased supervision;
- Written warning;
- Restriction or suspension of system access;
- Removal from particular responsibilities;
- Corrective-action planning;
- Termination of employment, contract, appointment, or affiliation;
- Recovery of Practice property or information;
- Reporting to licensing boards, regulators, law enforcement, or other authorities when required or appropriate; and
- Other legal or contractual remedies.

Nothing in this section limits Liminal's ability to take immediate action when necessary to protect patients, systems, or the Practice.

28. DOCUMENTATION AND RECORD RETENTION

Liminal will maintain required HIPAA policies, procedures, acknowledgments, training documentation, incident documentation, risk assessments, sanctions documentation, and related compliance records for the period required by applicable law.

Clinical and patient records shall be retained according to applicable federal and state requirements, payer obligations, professional standards, litigation holds, and Liminal's record-retention policy.

Workforce members shall not independently destroy, alter, or retain Practice records outside the authorized record-retention process.

29. POLICY REVIEW AND AMENDMENT

Liminal may revise this Policy in response to:

- Changes in law or regulation;
- Changes in Practice operations;
- New technology or vendors;
- New clinical or administrative workflows;
- Security-risk assessments;
- Privacy or security incidents;
- Audit findings; or
- Guidance from legal counsel, regulators, insurers, or cybersecurity professionals.

The Policy will be reviewed periodically and at least annually as a Liminal internal compliance standard.

Workforce members may be required to complete additional training and sign an updated acknowledgment following a material revision.

30. QUESTIONS

Questions about patient privacy, security requirements, permissible disclosures, approved technology, or this Policy must be directed to the Privacy Officer or Security Officer before taking action.

When uncertain, the workforce member should pause the activity, protect the information, and request guidance.

WORKFORCE ACKNOWLEDGMENT AND AGREEMENT

By signing below, I acknowledge and agree that:

1. I have received, reviewed, and understand the Liminal Psychiatry, LLC Privacy, Security, Confidentiality, and HIPAA Compliance Policy.
2. I have had an opportunity to ask questions concerning this Policy.
3. I agree to protect the privacy, confidentiality, integrity, and security of all patient and Practice information.
4. I will access PHI only when required for an authorized responsibility and will limit my access, use, and disclosure to the minimum information reasonably necessary.

5. I will use only Liminal-approved accounts, systems, devices, communication methods, vendors, and workflows.
6. I will not share passwords or use another individual's account.
7. I will not place PHI into an unapproved artificial-intelligence, transcription, automation, messaging, software-development, or third-party tool.
8. I will immediately report any actual or suspected privacy or security incident and will do so no later than twenty-four hours after discovery.
9. I understand that I must report an incident even when it was accidental, caused by me, appears minor, or may have been corrected.
10. I understand that my confidentiality obligations continue after my employment, contract, assignment, or relationship with Liminal ends.
11. I agree to complete all required HIPAA, privacy, security, cybersecurity, and Practice-specific training.
12. I understand that violation of this Policy may result in restriction of access, disciplinary action, termination of employment or contract, and other actions permitted or required by law.
13. I understand that this acknowledgment does not replace any Business Associate Agreement, employment agreement, independent-contractor agreement, confidentiality agreement, or other agreement applicable to my role.
14. I agree to return or securely destroy PHI and Liminal property as directed when my access or relationship with Liminal ends.

WORKFORCE MEMBER

Printed Name: _____

Title/Role: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

LIMINAL PSYCHIATRY, LLC

Authorized Representative: Shelley Padgett

Title: Founder/CEO

Signature: *Shelley Padgett*

Date: 07/16/2026

APPENDIX A

APPROVED SYSTEMS REGISTER

The following systems are approved only for the purposes and users authorized by Liminal. Approval may be modified or withdrawn at any time.

1. Liminal-Managed Google Workspace

Authorized Uses: Practice email, approved document storage, approved internal collaboration.

Restrictions: No forwarding to personal accounts. PHI may be stored only in approved locations with appropriate access controls.

2. Spruce

Authorized Uses: Patient telephone calls, approved messaging, and other authorized patient communications.

Restrictions: The encrypted Spruce application is preferred for sensitive communication. Standard SMS use must follow Liminal's communication policy.

3. Electronic Health Record and Practice-Management Systems

Approved System or Systems: Headway, Simple Practice, Liminal developed systems

Authorized Uses: Clinical documentation, scheduling, patient records, billing, and other authorized operations.

4. Electronic-Signature Platform

Approved System: SignNow

Authorized Uses: Patient forms, authorizations, contracts, and approved document execution.

5. Slack or Other Internal Liminal Collaboration Platform

Approval Status:

- ☒ Approved for limited PHI workflows
- ☐ Approved for non-PHI use only
- ☐ Not approved for PHI

6. Telehealth Platform

Approved System: Headway, Simple Practice, Liminal developed systems

7. Billing and Credentialing Systems

Approved System or Systems: Headway, Simple Practice, Liminal developed systems

8. Artificial-Intelligence, Transcription, or Automation Systems

No artificial-intelligence, transcription, or automation system is approved for PHI.

Any system not approved in writing shall be treated as unapproved for PHI.

Shelley Padgett

07/16/2026